

Additions to the Training Plan and Literature References

1. Additions to the Training Plan

Tactics: Starting with The Manual of Chess Combinations

The tactics book *The Manual of Chess Combinations* is recommended for developing tactical understanding from 0 to approximately 800–1000 Elo. The positions are trivial; the main purpose is pattern recognition. There is no need to set up the positions on a board.

Preparation for Yusupov's Training Series

My program, Parts 4–9, is intended as preparatory work for Books 1–3 of Yusupov's Training Series. These books are excellent, but they require prior knowledge. This prior knowledge is covered by my video course.

Yusupov's Training Series by Artur Yusupov

Yusupov's Training Series is extremely good. The author, Artur Yusupov, is the founder of the FIDE Academy „Jussupow Schachschule“ I worked for. He was once ranked No. 3 in the world and is a world-renowned, high-level trainer.

His book series received the Boleslavsky Medal and has been regarded as a top book series for years. Each of the 24 chapters in a book could serve as a separate three-hour seminar for which participation might cost €10–20. The series is therefore extraordinarily valuable.

One remark only: the chapters containing specific opening recommendations, for example a repertoire against the French Defence, are no longer up to date and should be skipped.

Cost and Scope of the Literature

The complete literature program would cost around €300 if all books were purchased new. However, it represents all the material that I consider necessary in addition to my course. For roughly five years of material, or development from 0 to expert level, €300 is not much.

Middlegame: Parts 10–19

My Parts 10–19 on the middlegame are not progressively built on one another. Part 10 explains the middlegame in general: how to make decisions, find a plan, and so on. It has its own PDF and is a central part of the program. Parts 11–19 cover individual aspects of the middlegame that are explained in Part 10.

Endgame: Parts 20–29

Similarly, Part 20 presents general endgame strategy, while the following parts cover individual aspects of the endgame. Part 20 is again very essential.

Level Classification

Within the individual parts, the level can range from 1500 to well above 2000. However, I believe players in the 1500–2000 range gain the most value from them. This does not mean that players rated 2000 cannot learn anything, especially if they do not have the same overview or foundation.

Independent Study

It is possible to follow my course without any additional literature, but it is considerably more effective with independent study. Without intensive training work – for example, by only playing games – I do not consider progress possible.

Dvoretsky's Endgame Manual

Dvoretsky's Endgame Manual covers theoretical endgames and is a top book. It is about 500 pages long and deals with theoretical endgames – in a sense, the end of endgames. It can be understood from around 1500 Elo. In particular, it is progressively structured chapter by chapter. I suspect, however, that it is relevant only to the most interested students because it can be dry. Nevertheless, it is very instructive.

Openings

Openings are a delicate subject: on the one hand, they can produce the fastest rating gains; on the other hand, pure opening study does not lead to intellectual (= long-term) improvement. For constructive improvement, I recommend starting concrete opening study as late as possible and keeping it general at the beginning. More in Part 40.

Further Notes

Choice of Books

There are certainly other books of equal quality. However, my trust, experience, and program are built around the books listed here. I do not want to deny the quality of other books; certainly, there are also books that are genuinely not recommendable. For my tested program, however, these works are perfect.

Further Study for Experts

In addition, there are books on super-expert subtleties, for example “Maneuvering” or “How to Win with the Bishop Pair.” I recommend these for further study once sufficient general chess knowledge has been acquired and the aim is simply to refine it.

If Your Goal Is Below 2000 Elo

If your goal does not go as far as, for example, reaching 2000 Elo, follow the plan anyway. The plan itself does not change. The only difference in the recommendations might be, for example, to play simpler and less theory-heavy openings.

Long-Term Potential

At the same time, the plan is good enough to take you in the direction of GM level, because there are no shortcuts. The foundation is laid consistently and without contradictions.

2. Literature References

Chess School 1A / The Manual of Chess Combinations

Chess School 1A (or Book 1 up to Exercise 719), The Manual of Chess Combinations. Recommended for 0–1000 Elo. A perfect book for progressing from zero to an initial level of tactical knowledge.

Combinational Motifs by Blokh / Chess School 6

Combinational Motifs by Blokh // Chess School 6 (later title). Tactical exercises at approximately 1200–2000+ level, 1200 exercises in total. Although it appears to be a jump from 1A to 6, this is still my recommendation. Blokh has existed for 30 years and was later added to the higher-level series.

Yusupov's Training Series by Artur Yusupov

All 9 books. Exception: the opening chapters; see the training-plan video in Playlist 3. Instead, from Playlist 40 onward, choose openings according to style, strength, and goals.

The order is: 1. Build up Your Chess: the Fundamentals, // 2. Boost Your Chess 1: The Fundamentals 3. Chess Evolution 1: The Fundamentals // 4. Build Up Your Chess 2: Beyond the Basics // ...

Also available on chessable

Dvoretsky's Endgame Manual

Theoretical endgames; all levels from 1500–2500 are covered.

Important Note on Part 10 and Part 20

Be sure to understand and keep in mind the self-developed / summarized PDF on middlegame strategy (Part 10) and endgame strategy (Part 20). It explains the correct decision-making process.